SharePoint SE + Nintex SE

Migration Test Plan · Mid-Level Runbook

PURPOSE

This guide describes a staged test approach for migrating SharePoint Server 2019 on-premises content databases to SharePoint Server Subscription Edition (SE), in environments where Nintex is also deployed on both the source and destination farms.

The migration is separated into two clear test phases: a **SharePoint-only** content database attach/upgrade test, followed by a **SharePoint + Nintex paired** migration test. The first phase proves that SharePoint sites open correctly in SE. The second phase validates that Nintex workflows, forms, history, and running workflow state migrate safely.

Important Principle

SharePoint content databases and Nintex databases must be treated as related application data. For a SharePoint-only test, mounting only the SharePoint content databases is acceptable. For any Nintex validation, the matching SharePoint content database and Nintex databases must come from the same controlled backup point.

RECOMMENDED OVERALL APPROACH

Phase 1	SharePoint-only database attach/upgrade test
Phase 2	Discard Phase 1 test databases (unless tightly controlled)
Phase 3	Clean SharePoint + Nintex paired migration test with fresh matching backups
Phase 4	Full dress rehearsal before production cutover
Phase 5	Plan production migration window only after successful testing

PHASE 1 SharePoint-Only Content Database Test

PURPOSE

This phase proves that SharePoint sites can be restored, mounted, upgraded, and opened in SharePoint SE. **This phase does not prove that Nintex works.**

EXPECTED OUTCOME

Migrated sites open in SharePoint SE. Testers should confirm:

- Site collections are accessible
- Home pages load correctly
- Document libraries and lists open
- Pages render without errors
- Permissions appear broadly correct
- Navigation works as expected
- Documents can be opened
- Basic SharePoint functionality is intact

Nintex workflows, forms, workflow history, status pages, and running workflow instances are not validated in this phase.

PRECONDITIONS

- SharePoint SE farm is installed and patched
- SharePoint SE web applications are created
- Managed paths, authentication, DNS, and alternate access mappings are configured
- Nintex SE is installed on the new farm (no connection to migrated Nintex databases needed for this phase)
- Test SQL databases are restored from copies of production SharePoint content databases

HIGH-LEVEL STEPS

1. Select the SharePoint content databases to test.
   Use one pilot content database, or all databases to prove all sites migrate.
2. Restore copies of the SharePoint content databases to the SE SQL environment.
   Use test database names to avoid confusion with production.
3. Mount the SharePoint content databases to the correct SharePoint SE web application.
4. Allow SharePoint to perform the required database/schema upgrade.
5. Review SharePoint upgrade status and upgrade logs.
6. Open each migrated site collection.

7. Perform basic SharePoint validation.
8. Record issues by site.
9. Label the test result as: SharePoint attach/upgrade test only — Nintex not validated.
10. Decide whether to keep or discard this test environment.

RECOMMENDATION

Treat this first test as disposable. Do not use it as the final Nintex validation baseline unless it was created using the exact same controlled database snapshot strategy required for the Nintex migration test.

RISKS / EXPECTED ISSUES IN PHASE 1

The following Nintex issues are **expected** and should not be treated as Phase 1 failures:

- Nintex forms not rendering
- Workflow status pages failing
- Workflow history missing or disconnected
- Workflow designer errors
- Running workflows not continuing
- Workflow tasks existing as SharePoint items but not behaving correctly

PHA
SE 2

Clean SharePoint + Nintex Paired Migration Test

PURPOSE

This phase proves that SharePoint content and Nintex data can be migrated together. This is the real technical migration test for Nintex.

EXPECTED OUTCOME

The migrated sites open in SharePoint SE and Nintex functions correctly. Validation includes:

- Existing Nintex workflows are visible
- Existing Nintex forms open
- Workflow history is visible
- Existing workflow tasks are visible
- New workflow instances can start
- In-progress workflow instances can resume where applicable
- Scheduled or auto-start workflows behave correctly
- Nintex database mappings are correct
- External workflow actions still work

PRECONDITIONS

- SharePoint SE farm is installed and working
- Nintex SE is installed on the new farm with licensing confirmed
- Destination SharePoint web applications exist
- The SharePoint-only test has already proven that sites can mount
- A pilot site/content database has been selected for the Nintex test
- Matching SharePoint and Nintex databases can be backed up from the same controlled source window

Important Rule — Database Snapshot Alignment

Do not mix database copies from different points in time. Avoid taking a SharePoint content database backup at one time and a Nintex Workflow database backup at a different time. Instead, freeze or quiet workflow activity and take SharePoint and Nintex backups from the same controlled migration window.

SOURCE FARM STEPS

1. Identify the SharePoint content database being tested.
2. Identify the matching Nintex Workflow content database.
3. Identify the relevant Nintex configuration database and Nintex Forms database if used.
4. Record the database mapping before migration.

5. Identify sample workflows for validation: one completed, one in-progress, one new start, one form-enabled, one auto-start, one with external actions.
6. Notify testers and business owners that a migration test snapshot is being taken.
7. Freeze or reduce workflow activity where practical.
8. Stop or pause workflow/timer activity for a consistent migration snapshot.
9. Run the Nintex detach process for the relevant Nintex Workflow content database.
10. Back up the SharePoint content database.
11. Back up the matching Nintex Workflow database.
12. Back up the Nintex configuration database if required.
13. Back up the Nintex Forms database if used.
14. Resume source farm activity if production must continue running.

DESTINATION FARM STEPS

1. Restore the SharePoint content database copy to the SE SQL environment.
2. Restore the matching Nintex Workflow database copy to the SE SQL environment.
3. Restore the Nintex Forms database copy if used.
4. Confirm Nintex SE is installed and available in Central Administration.
5. Mount the SharePoint content database to the correct SharePoint SE web application.
6. Allow SharePoint to complete the content database upgrade.
7. Attach the matching Nintex Workflow content database using the Nintex supported method.
8. Connect/configure the Nintex Forms database if used.
9. Confirm Nintex database mappings.
10. Confirm Nintex features are active on the required web applications and site collections.
11. Restart services or run IIS reset only where required by the procedure.
12. Re-enable workflow/timer activity when ready for validation.

VALIDATION STEPS

SharePoint

- Site opens without errors
- Pages load correctly
- Lists and libraries open
- Permissions appear correct
- Documents can be opened

Nintex Forms

- New, edit, and display forms open
- Form can be submitted
- People picker, lookup, and repeating section fields work
- Custom JavaScript/CSS works if used

Completed Workflows

- Workflow status is visible
- Workflow history and tasks display correctly
- Completed results are still understandable

New Workflow Instances

- Start a new workflow and confirm it enters running state
- Confirm tasks, emails, and actions are created
- Complete the workflow and confirm final status and history

In-Progress Workflows

- Open a workflow that was in progress at migration time
- Confirm it still shows as in progress
- Complete the pending action and confirm the workflow continues to the expected next step

Auto-Start Workflows

- Create and modify test items and confirm expected workflows start
- Confirm no duplicate or old-farm references are triggered

External Dependencies

- Email actions
- Web service calls
- SQL actions
- Document generation
- AD/user lookups
- External connector actions
- Workflow constants, service accounts, and stored credentials

PASS / FAIL CRITERIA

Phase 2 is only considered successful when all of the following are confirmed:

- SharePoint sites open correctly

- Nintex forms open and can be submitted
- Existing workflow history is accessible
- New workflows can start and complete
- At least one in-progress workflow resumes successfully
- Critical external workflow actions are tested and working
- Nintex database mappings are correct
- No old server names or URLs are causing functional issues

PHASE 3 Full Dress Rehearsal

PURPOSE

This phase proves the end-to-end migration approach using the same sequence that will be used in production.

EXPECTED OUTCOME

A complete migration runbook with timings, issues, fixes, and rollback notes ready for production use.

HIGH-LEVEL STEPS

1. Select all databases in migration scope.
2. Confirm SharePoint-to-Nintex database mappings.
3. Confirm downtime and change window requirements.
4. Run the full migration sequence using copies of production databases.
5. Time each major step.
   Database backup · Database restore · SharePoint mount/upgrade · Nintex attach · Forms connection · Validation
6. Record every command or admin action used.
7. Record every error encountered and how it was resolved.
8. Run business validation.
9. Confirm the rollback process.
10. Produce the final production cutover checklist.

PHASE 4 Production Cutover

PURPOSE

This phase performs the real production migration. Only proceed after successful SharePoint-only testing, paired Nintex testing, and a full dress rehearsal.

PRODUCTION SEQUENCE

1. Confirm change approval.
2. Confirm business communication has been sent.

3. Confirm final backup and rollback plan.
4. Freeze user changes.
5. Stop or pause workflow/timer activity as required.
6. Run Nintex detach process on source Nintex Workflow content databases.
7. Back up SharePoint content databases.
8. Back up Nintex Workflow databases.
9. Back up Nintex Forms databases.
10. Restore databases to the destination SQL environment.
11. Mount SharePoint content databases in SharePoint SE.
12. Allow SharePoint database upgrades to complete.
13. Attach Nintex Workflow databases using the Nintex supported method.
14. Connect Nintex Forms databases.
15. Confirm database mappings.
16. Activate and confirm required Nintex features.
17. Re-enable services, timer jobs, and workflow activity.
18. Run technical validation.
19. Run business validation.
20. Release the system to users.
21. Keep the old farm in a safe rollback/read-only state until the rollback window expires.

RECOMMENDED COMMUNICATIONS TO STAKEHOLDERS

For the SharePoint-Only Test

“This test is intended to prove that the SharePoint sites can be migrated and opened in SharePoint SE. It does not validate Nintex workflows, Nintex Forms, workflow history, or running workflow state. Nintex will be tested separately in a later paired migration test.”

For the Nintex Paired Test

“This test validates the full SharePoint and Nintex migration path, including SharePoint content, Nintex workflows, forms, workflow history, and selected running workflow scenarios.”

For Production Cutover

“The production cutover will migrate SharePoint content databases and their matching Nintex databases together from the same controlled migration window. Workflow activity will be paused during the final backup and migration period to reduce risk of inconsistent workflow state.”

KEY DECISIONS TO RECORD

- Which SharePoint content databases are in scope?
- Which site collections are in each content database?
- Which Nintex Workflow content database maps to each SharePoint content database?
- Is Nintex Forms in use, and which Nintex Forms database is in scope?
- Are there any workflows currently in progress, long-running, or scheduled?
- Are there workflows using external systems?
- Are there workflow constants or stored credentials that need review?
- Will the SharePoint-only test database be discarded?
- What is the rollback plan?
- What is the final outage window?
- Who signs off SharePoint validation?
- Who signs off Nintex validation?

BOTTOM LINE — SAFE MIGRATION APPROACH

1. Run a SharePoint-only content database attach/upgrade test first.
2. Clearly state that Nintex is not validated in that test.
3. Treat the first test as disposable unless it was tightly controlled.
4. For real Nintex testing, start again with fresh matching SharePoint and Nintex database backups.
5. Mount SharePoint content databases first.
6. Attach the matching Nintex Workflow databases second.
7. Connect Nintex Forms databases if used.
8. Validate forms, history, new workflows, and in-progress workflows.
9. Only then prepare the production cutover plan.